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AFP

■ Students attend their class at a government school in Lahore yesterday, after schools reopened following a ceasefire between Pakistan and India.

Modi says 'a new line has been drawn' against terrorism

Trump reveals trade talks with India under way, to begin soon with Pakistan

NEW DELHI

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi said yesterday that Operation Sindoor (military action against alleged terrorist hideouts) is now India's new policy against terrorism and "a new line has been drawn".

Referring to the deadly Pahalgam terror attack that claimed 26 civilian lives, Modi called the assault "the most barbaric face of terrorism".

Lauding defence forces for carrying out Operation Sindoor, Modi said, "India's armed forces carried out precise strikes on terrorist hideouts and training centres. The terrorists could never have imagined even in their dreams that India could take such a bold decision."

Trump said he believed his intervention helped avert what he believes could have escalated into a nuclear conflict between the two countries.

Meanwhile, US President Donald Trump yesterday claimed he pressured India and Pakistan into accepting a ceasefire over the weekend by threatening to cut off trade with both countries.

Trade diplomacy

"I said, come on, we're going to do a lot of trade with you guys. Let's stop it. Let's stop it. If you stop it, we'll do a trade. If you don't stop it, we're not going to do any trade,'" Trump told reporters at the White House.

Trump said he believed his intervention helped avert what he believes could have escalated into a nuclear conflict between the two countries.

He also confirmed that the US will "do a lot of trade" with both countries, adding that negotiations with India are ongoing while talks with Pakistan will begin shortly.

Trump also said he was proud of the way both countries handled the crisis, "I'm very proud to let you know that the leadership of India and Pakistan was unwavering and powerful, but unwavering in both cases — they really were from the standpoint of having the strength and the wisdom and fortitude to fully know and to understand the gravity of the situation."

— *Agencies*

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UAE leads the way in human development

ONLY ARAB NATION IN TOP 20; AHEAD OF US, CANADA AND JAPAN GLOBALLY

ABU DHABI

The UAE has maintained its leading position among countries with "very high human development" climbing 11 spots globally in the 2025 Human Development Index (HDI) report issued by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), compared to its 2021-2022 ranking.

The UAE ranked 15th globally out of 193 countries covered by the report, outperforming nations including Canada, the United States, Japan, Australia, and Korea. It remains the only Arab country in the top 20, a distinction reflecting its commitment to a comprehensive development vision that prioritises human wellbeing. The country's approach integrates health care, education, and quality of life, positioning it as a global model for sustainability and human capital development.

Placed high

The 2025 Human Development Report "A matter of choice: people and possibilities in the age of Artificial Intelligence (AI)", gave the UAE an HDI score of 0.94. According to the four main indicators: life expectancy at birth in the UAE reached 82.9 years, aligned with Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 3 on "Good Health and Well-being"; expected years of schooling stood at 15.6, and average years of schooling at 13, supporting SGD 4 on quality education. Gross national income per capita reached $71.142, contributing to SDG 8 on decent work and economic growth.

Abdul Rahman Bin Mohammad Al Owais, Minister of Health and Prevention, said the UAE's leading position reflects its sustained investment in a world-class health care system that promotes innovation and ensures high-quality services. Sara Bint Yousef Al Amiri, Minister of Education, stressed that education has always been central to the UAE's development strategy. She highlighted the adoption of adaptive, forward-looking education policies designed to prepare future generations for competitiveness and innovation, particularly in fields such as artificial intelligence.

The UAE also ranked third globally in net migration of AI-skilled professionals in 2023, based on LinkedIn data. — *WAM*

SEE ALSO P8

DUBAI 4TH GLOBALLY IN SMART CITY INDEX

Dubai has advanced eight places to rank 4th globally in the IMD Smart City Index 2025, marking a major milestone in its digital transformation journey. The achievement reinforces Dubai's position as the highest-ranked city in the GCC, the Arab world and Asia, and highlights its status as a global leader in smart city development and future-ready urban innovation.

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